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Models Handoff Guide

Use this guide when you need to describe **data shapes that cross boundaries or are shown clearly to users or other systems**.

This guide is about **what information is carried**, **how it is grouped**, and **what it represents**.

KNOWLEDGE AREA

This guide helps with **information shapes and views**. Technically, it covers **information structures and data representations**.

Guide family map

Where this guide sits in the full Blueprint Handoff Atlas family.

ROOT & CROSS-CUTTING

Handoff Atlas | Blueprint Bundle | Metamodel Vocabulary | Migrations

DESIGN

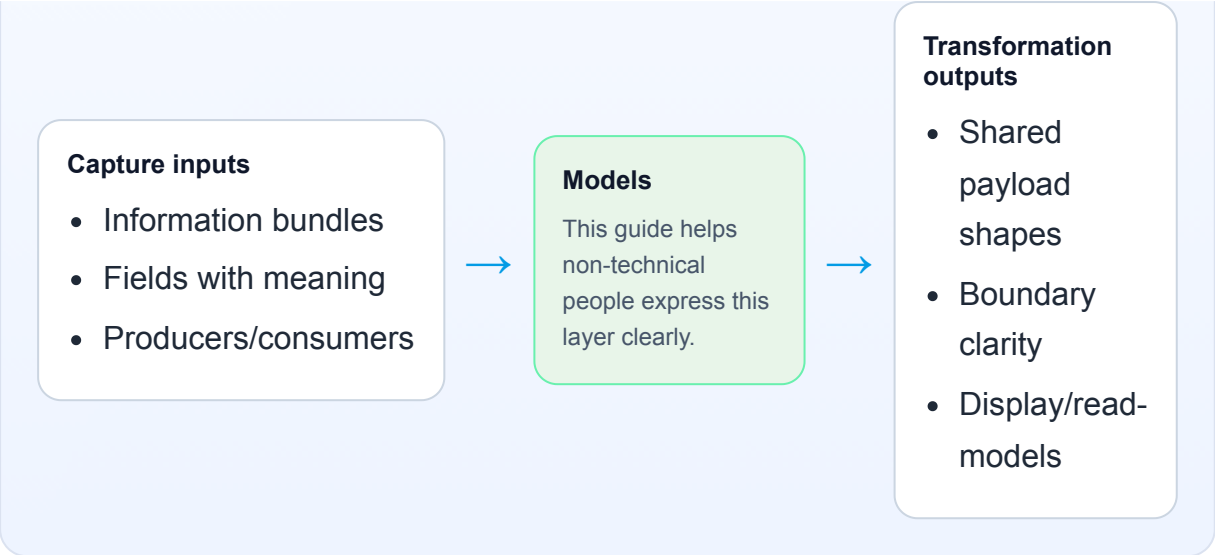
Architecture | Concepts | Domain | Dynamics | Infrastructure | Interactions | **Models** | Quality | Rules | Story

GOVERNANCE

Capability | Decisions | Motivation | Organization | Roadmap | Leverage | Test Cases | Value Stream

Capture → focus → transformation

What to gather first, what this layer focuses on, and what a modeler or AI agent can produce from it.



Main entities in this guide

- **Components** - the container that holds the reusable model pieces for this guide.
- **Schema** - a reusable data shape inside **Component Schemas**.
- **Reusable Field** - a reusable single field definition used in many shapes.
- **Reusable Parameter** - a reusable operation parameter, such as a path, query, or header input.
- **Represents** - an optional mapping that says which business **Concept** a model shape stands for.
    - Often confused with: **Concept** in the Concepts guide. Models describe the information shape; concepts describe the business meaning.

What belongs here

- request payload shapes
- event payload shapes
- read models shown to users
- shared data transfer objects
- reusable fields or parameters when they have stable meaning

What does not belong here

- business concept meaning by itself
- UI flow behavior
- purely internal technical structures with no cross-boundary value

Core things to capture

- what information package exists
- what it is used for
- what main fields it contains
- what concept or business meaning it represents
- who sends or receives it

Core relationships to capture

- model -> concept represented
- model -> operation using it
- model -> screen or view showing it
- field -> business meaning

Modus operandi

Think in information bundles:

1. identify what data crosses a boundary or is shown together
2. describe its purpose
3. list the important fields in business language
4. explain what concept it represents
5. note who produces and consumes it

Prompt set

- what information travels together?
- why does this shape exist?
- who sends it and who receives it?
- what business concept does it represent?
- which fields are essential to understand the payload?

Free-text intake template

- **Model name:**
- **Purpose:**
- **Produced by / consumed by:**
- **Represents:**
- **Important fields:**
- **Where it is displayed or used:**

Worked example

- Return Request Summary model is used on the customer account page and support review page
- It represents a return request and includes order number, items, status, and refund summary

Layer-specific handoff guidance

For models, the handoff should preserve **information shape and business meaning together**.

Make sure the receiver can see:

- what bundle of information exists
- why that bundle exists
- who produces or consumes it
- what concept it represents

Field lists without meaning are weak handoffs; add purpose and representation context.

How this becomes YAML

A technical modeler or AI agent can transform this into reusable data models and field definitions linked to operations, concepts, and views.

Common mistakes

- listing every storage column instead of the meaningful data shape
- omitting the purpose of the model
- describing fields with technical names only
- forgetting what concept the model represents